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details about the game in relevant document using Microsoft Word.

Also, in this industry you have to keep up with the rest. Strength wise, it is a very small industry and everyone knows everyone. You will almost certainly work with a lot of people you meet in one or the other form. You would essentially need to network with other Developers around the world and go to events like GDC, Casual Connect, PAX etc to get some exposure.

As of today, In India - NASSCOM Gaming Forum on Facebook is a hangout place for the local Game Developers. It's a nice place to talk to professionals and get advice and even share ideas.

videos on this topic. One could easily experiment the whacky new ideas they might have and even prototype them if they know a programmer or can program themselves. And if you find yourself at home, you are more than welcome!

How do you convince your parents if you are too young?

"And how much does your girl / boy earn?" This is the age-old question parents (especially in India) dread. There is one thing the better part of this Industry expects you to have - an attitude where you don't work for money but for the craft of it. Of course... it is not like they are not

package?" you would be treated that way. It could be your second question... This industry expects passion first!

Options: Schools, Self-Learning, Mentoring?

Now then, what are your options if you want to train yourself to be a Game Designer? The good news is that there is no pre-determined path to this career.

In India, your options are limited. An unbiased personal recommendation as an author of this article would be DSK Supinfogame, Pune which happens to be my Alma-mater. The reason being their approach towards educating you in this craft is 100% practical. They train you via projects (that become a part of your portfolio) and by the time you graduate - you know how to work in teams and make projects possible and design really good games. All their faculty are professionals from the western gaming Industry and they seem to know what they are doing. I can't recommend any other school (Most Indian schools confuse Game Design and Game Art themselves!). Digipen, VFS and CMU are other schools abroad that will provide the kind of education that you need. Also, try to make sure the program is practical and that it is *at least* 2 years in duration.

What to avoid

1. A school that says that they will teach you Game Engines (Let's describe these as "they are softwares / middleware used to make games") should sound alarms. A Game designer knows to be resourceful enough to learn things on their own. Approach a school that teaches you how to work with the tools rather than just teaches you the tools.
2. Any guarantee of salary packages, getting jobs, internships and placements should sound alarms. There are a lot of 'Diploma-mills' cropping up at every nook-and-corner of the country trying to make a quick buck off kids who are just excited about gaming and parents who are worried about salaries. A lot of such institutes even end up hiring their own alumni for meager pay-scales. A good school will have enough reputation in the market



Where to start becoming a Game Designer? Is it too late?

OK, so you are finally starting to get a better picture in your mind about this and you think want to make games. But wait... you are already working somewhere and it is not a Game Studio. What now? Is it too late now? The simple answer is NO! Back in my Game Design school, we had students aged 17 to 32; one student being a lawyer-turned-Game Designer with a PhD. All that matters is passion coupled with practicality. If you are determined, you could always explore by learning things on your own. There are a lot of books, resources and

going to pay you. But you will be hired for your work. No certificate from any school or college is going to get you into this Industry. Sorry to sound scary, but your certificates would be pieces of paper. Your 98.23% in SSC will *not* ensure a job in this Industry. Neither will being an IITian. Nothing but your work can. You develop your skills, your score a nice job, you get paid handsomely, it is that straightforward. You bargain for your value to the studio. Especially in India, unlike Engineering, There is NO standard pay scale for a Game Designer. It may range between 20k a month to more than a lakh depending on your skill. And If the very first question you ask will be "What is the